Vasilen Kanchev

Data Engineer

Porto, Portugal | EU citizen (Bulgarian), no visa needed | +351 931 673 151 | vasilen.business@gmail.com | LinkedIn | GitHub | Portfolio

PROJECTS

Wikipedia Streaming Lakehouse | Kafka, Spark Structured Streaming, DuckDB, Terraform
Wikipedia edits through Kafka and Spark into Parquet, late and malformed events handled, tested on real Kafka in CI. Terraform validated, not deployed. github.com/VasilenData/wiki-stream-lakehouse

NYC Taxi Data Platform | Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Docker
31.6M trips with an enforced data contract; every rejected row (2.8%) kept in a quarantine table with its reason; blocking checks stop a corrupted month. 10 months build in 62 s. github.com/VasilenData/nyc-taxi-data-platform

HN Pulse: Live Data Pipeline | Python, dbt, Airflow, DuckDB, GitHub Actions
Hacker News API through dbt models (27 data tests, enforced contracts) into DuckDB, with a freshness gate; failing tests block the live dashboard update. vasilendata.github.io/hn-pulse/

Taxi Trip Duration Service | LightGBM, FastAPI, MLflow, Docker
Time-split model with 62% lower error than a baseline on a held-out month (3.52 vs 9.33 min); champion/challenger promotion, validated API, drift monitoring, 4 ms p50 latency. github.com/VasilenData/taxi-eta-service

Evaluated AI Research Assistant | llama.cpp, BM25, fastembed, NLI
Local 1.5B model over 2,835 arXiv abstracts; retrieval lifts answers with the reference fact from 3.8% to 50.6%, a gate blocks fabricated-topic answers, judge accuracy 85.5% reported. github.com/VasilenData/research-assistant-eval

WORK EXPERIENCE

Data Engineer | Gosian Media LLC
South Carolina | June 2025 - Present

- Joined when monthly revenue was about $80K; built the data systems behind its growth to about $600K a month (7.5x).
- Cut cost of goods sold by about $10K a month and raised profit by $60K+ a month after all expenses, through data-driven cost and performance tracking.
- Built a PostgreSQL database on AWS RDS, migrating 30+ legacy spreadsheets into a normalized relational schema.
- Built Docker-based Python pipelines pulling REST API and web data, with dbt transformations and automated validation tests that catch bad data before analysis; replaced 10+ hours a week of manual data entry.

Data Analyst | Influencer Marketing Hub
United Kingdom | November 2023 - June 2025

- Analyzed influencer engagement, audience demographics and campaign performance datasets to support marketing strategy and campaign decisions.
- Automated daily and weekly KPI reporting with Python and Tableau, eliminating manual aggregation and scaling reporting visibility for 15+ stakeholders.
- Developed ETL workflows to extract, clean and standardize data from social media APIs for analysis and reporting.
- Helped design campaign A/B tests, assess statistical significance, and present findings to senior stakeholders.

Data Administrator / Operations Analyst | TapIn Platforms, Inc.
Miami, Florida | October 2021 - November 2023

- Managed relational databases, performing daily validation and record updates to support accurate operational data.
- Used advanced Excel and SQL to identify business trends, track user growth and report on operational metrics.
- Identified inefficiencies in raw data collection and proposed software solutions that centralized the company's internal knowledge base.
- Supported product and marketing teams with ad hoc data requests and SQL queries to extract specific user cohorts.

Operations & Data Assistant | CoEfficient & NPC
Johannesburg, South Africa | July 2019 - September 2021

- Digitized legacy records, validated daily operational data and ran monthly reconciliations across CRM, inventory and finance systems.

Professional Coach and Player | Valorant Friends League & Community
Deggendorf, Germany | 2020 - 2025, alongside full-time roles

- Reached the #1 global VALORANT ranking, substituted for a Tier 1 organization, and won multiple international LAN tournaments across Europe.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Python, SQL (PostgreSQL), Bash, AWS RDS, Docker, dbt, Apache Airflow, DuckDB, Kafka, Spark, Polars, Terraform, Dagster, MLflow, FastAPI, GitHub Actions, Tableau, Pandas, Scikit-Learn

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

University of Suffolk | BSc (Hons) Computer Science | Expected 2027
UNISA | Mathematics and Statistics Higher Certificate (Distinction) | 2024
Certifications: Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate; IBM Data Engineering Certificate